

HIGHER SECONDARY SECOND YEAR (H.S. 2nd Year)
POLITICAL SCIENCE – 2023 (Code: 33T POSC)

Solved Question Paper (Guide)

Full Marks: 100 | Time: 3 Hours

Note: As this is a guide, all questions are solved, including every 'OR' / 'Any ____' question.

PART – A : Contemporary World Politics

Q.1 (1 mark each)

Q.1(a) In the Second World War, a member of the Axis Powers was the US / Soviet Union / Germany.

Ans:

Germany.

Q.1(b) How many independent states emerged from the disintegration of the Soviet Union?

Ans:

15.

Q.1(c) In which year the 9/11 terrorist attack on the United States was carried out?

Ans:

2001.

Q.1(d) In which year was Bangladesh born as an independent country?

Ans:

1971.

Q.1(e) In which country was the Earth Summit held in 1992?

Ans:

Brazil (Rio de Janeiro).

Q.1(f) Write the full form of UNEP.

Ans:

United Nations Environment Programme.

Q.1(g) Who is the present Secretary General of U.N.O?

Ans:

António Guterres (Portugal), since 2017.

Q.1(h) When did Cuban Missile crisis occur?

Ans:

1962.

Q.1(i) Berlin Wall was demolished in the year _____.

Ans:

1989.

Q.1(j) The collapse of which country is known as the collapse of the 'Second World'?

Ans:

The Soviet Union (USSR).

Q.2 (2 marks each)

Q.2(a) Mention two consequences of the end of the Cold War.

Ans:

- Collapse of the Soviet Union and the end of the bipolar world; the USA became the only superpower (unipolar world).
- End of the arms race and ideological conflict; new independent states emerged and many countries adopted capitalism.

Q.2(b) Which were the member countries of ASEAN when it was formed in 1967?

Ans:

ASEAN was formed on 8 August 1967 by five countries: Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore and Thailand.

Q.2(c) What is the difference between Deterrence and Defence?

Ans:

- Deterrence means preventing war by threatening an attacker with unbearable punishment (e.g., nuclear weapons); it aims to stop a war from starting.
- Defence means taking action to stop an attack or to limit damage and end the war once it has begun.

Q.2(d) Mention any two areas or regions of the world known as Global Commons.

Ans:

- Antarctica and the Arctic region
- The earth's atmosphere/ozone layer, the ocean floor and outer space

Q.2(e) Mention two causes of Globalisation.

Ans:

- Advances in technology (communication, internet, transport) that connected the world.
- Economic liberalisation and growth of world trade, MNCs and international institutions like the WTO.

Q.2(f) Mention two economic consequences of Globalisation.

Ans:

- Increase in world trade, foreign investment and growth of multinational companies.
- Widening gap between rich and poor, and loss of jobs/damage to local industries in some countries.

Q.2(g) Mention two conceptions of Security.

Ans:

- Traditional concept: threat to state sovereignty and territory from military force.
- Non-traditional concept: threats to human beings such as poverty, epidemics, terrorism and environmental damage (human security).

Q.2(h) Mention two areas of conflict between India and China.

Ans:

- Border dispute (Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin; the 1962 war and later clashes such as Galwan, 2020).
- Tibet and the Dalai Lama issue, and China's close ties with Pakistan.

Q.2(i) Write down the names of the Permanent Member States of Security Council of U.N.O.

Ans:

The five Permanent Members of the Security Council are the USA, Russia (earlier USSR), the United Kingdom, France and China. They have the power of veto.

Q.2(j) Write two constraints on American hegemony.

Ans:

- Institutional architecture of the American political system (separation of powers and checks and balances) limits the unchecked use of military power.
- Open nature of American society (public opinion, e.g., in the Vietnam war) and the role of alliances like NATO and rising powers like China restrain US dominance.

Q.3 (4 marks each)

Q.3(a) Discuss how the policy of non-alignment helped India during Cold War period.

Ans:

Non-alignment helped India during the Cold War:

- It kept India away from the two military blocs, so India could take independent decisions on world issues in its national interest.
- India could get aid and support from both the USA and USSR (e.g., steel plants from USSR and food aid from the USA).
- It raised India's prestige as the leader of the Third World, and helped in NAM, Afro-Asian unity and the anti-colonial movement.
- It helped India to focus on development instead of an arms race and to keep the Cold War out of South Asia.

Q.3(b) Briefly discuss the factors that forced Gorbachev to initiate reforms in the Soviet Union.

Ans:

Factors that forced Gorbachev to reform the Soviet Union:

- The Soviet economy was stagnating: low growth, shortage of goods and technological backwardness compared to the West.
- Heavy military expenditure and the arms race with the USA, plus the Afghan war, drained the resources.
- Corruption, inefficiency and bureaucracy in the Communist Party, and growing public discontent and demand for freedom.
- The Western prosperity (seen through communication) and the need to catch up with the West, and nationalist demands in the republics.

Q.3(c) Mention two economic and two military influence of the European Union.

Ans:

Economic and military influence of the EU:

- Economic: (i) it has the world's second-largest economy/ largest trading bloc; (ii) the euro is a strong currency and the EU has a major share in the WTO.
- Military: (i) it has the world's second-largest military budget (members' combined); (ii) two members, Britain and France, have nuclear weapons, and EU members have their own forces for peacekeeping.

Q.3(d) Mention two areas of co-operation and two areas of disagreement between India and Bangladesh.

Ans:

Two areas of cooperation:

- Trade and connectivity, and the Land Boundary Agreement (2015).
- Water sharing (Farakka Treaty 1996) and cooperation in power/energy and security matters.

Two areas of disagreement:

- Teesta river water sharing.
- Illegal migration, border management and smuggling.

Q.3(e) Write a note on the idea of global security.

Ans:

Global security means security of the whole world and its people, beyond the borders of one nation. It rests on the idea that many threats are global in nature and need cooperation: terrorism, nuclear weapons, climate change, epidemics, human rights violations and poverty. It includes both traditional (war, arms control, disarmament) and non-traditional threats (human security). Institutions like the UN, WHO and treaties like NPT help in providing global security.

Q.3(f) Write a note on the anti-globalisation movement.

Ans:

Anti-globalisation movements are protests against the economic, social and cultural effects of globalisation, mainly of neoliberal policies. They claim that globalisation benefits rich countries and MNCs, and harms the poor, workers, farmers and the environment.

- Examples: the 1999 Seattle protests against the WTO, the World Social Forum (Porto Alegre, 2001), the Occupy movement and protests by farmers and trade unions in India.
- Many such movements are not against globalisation of ideas or human rights, but they want a fairer system ('alter-globalisation').

Q.3(g) What are the grounds on which India supports the restructuring of U.N.O.? Discuss.

Ans:

India supports restructuring of the UN because:

- The UN's Security Council is not representative: Asia, Africa and Latin America lack permanent seats though they have the majority of the world's people.
- India is the world's largest democracy and the most populous country, a major economy, and has been a large contributor of peacekeepers; it therefore deserves a permanent seat.
- The veto power should be reformed, and the UN should be made more democratic and responsive to the needs of the developing world; the 1945 balance of power has changed.

Q.3(h) Discuss in brief the functions of the World Bank.

Ans:

The World Bank (IBRD) was set up in 1944 at the Bretton Woods Conference. Its functions are:

- To give long-term loans to member countries for reconstruction and development projects (roads, dams, power, schools, health).
- To provide technical advice and expertise to developing countries.
- To reduce poverty and promote economic growth and social development.
- To encourage foreign private investment and balanced growth of international trade.

Q.4 (6 marks each)

Q.4(a) Discuss U.S. hegemony as the World Superpower.

Ans:

Hegemony means the leadership or dominance of one state over others. After the end of the Cold War (1991) and the Gulf War (1991), the USA became the sole superpower.

- Military power: the USA has the strongest and technologically most advanced army (with 800+ bases around the world), and its military expenditure is greater than the next several countries combined; e.g., the Iraq war (2003).
- Economic power (structural power): it dominates the world economy through the dollar, the IMF, World Bank and WTO and has the largest economy.
- Soft power: its culture, films, universities, language and media attract the world.
- The USA also intervened in Kosovo, Afghanistan and Iraq; however, it faces challenges from China and Russia, and from its own limits (e.g., after 9/11).

Q.4(b) Discuss how health epidemics are new threat to global security.

Ans:

Human security means protection of people from threats like hunger, disease, violence and poverty. Health is a basic part of it:

- Epidemics and pandemics such as HIV/AIDS, SARS, bird flu, Ebola and COVID-19 kill many people and spread across borders because of travel and trade.
- Poor health reduces people's ability to work, causing poverty, and it harms the economy and social stability.
- Health problems are linked to poverty, malnutrition, poor sanitation and conflict, so states must cooperate through the WHO to guarantee health security.

Q.4(c) Do you think that India should be given permanent membership in the UN Security Council? Justify your answer.

Ans:

Yes, India should get a permanent seat in the UN Security Council, for these reasons:

- India is the world's most populous country and the largest democracy.
- It is among the largest economies in the world, and is a nuclear power with a peaceful record.
- India has made the highest contribution to UN peacekeeping missions and has been elected many times as a non-permanent member.
- The Council is unrepresentative without India and the developing world, so a permanent seat would make it more legitimate.

However, China's opposition and the veto of the P5 make it difficult.

Q.4(d) Write a note on the principal organs of the United Nations.

Ans:

The principal organs of the UN are:

- General Assembly: the main deliberative body with all members (one vote each); it passes the budget and elects non-permanent members.
- Security Council: 15 members (5 permanent with veto) responsible for peace and security.
- Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC): 54 members, works on economic and social development.
- Trusteeship Council: looked after trust territories; suspended its work in 1994.

- International Court of Justice (ICJ): at The Hague, with 15 judges, settles legal disputes between states.
- Secretariat: headed by the Secretary-General (currently António Guterres), does the administrative work.

PART – B : Politics in India Since Independence

Q.5 (1 mark each)

Q.5(a) In which state of India, for the first time in the world, a Communist Party government came to power through democratic election?

Ans:

Kerala (1957, under E.M.S. Namboodiripad).

Q.5(b) _____ was the chairman of the Drafting Committee of the Constituent Assembly.

Ans:

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar.

Q.5(c) Where was the first Summit of NAM held?

Ans:

Belgrade (Yugoslavia), 1961.

Q.5(d) China invaded India in 1960/1962/1964.

Ans:

1962.

Q.5(e) Mention the name of a prominent leader of the Narmada Bachao Movement.

Ans:

Medha Patkar (also Baba Amte).

Q.5(f) When was the State Reorganisation Act passed?

Ans:

1956.

Q.5(g) The Right to Information Act came into force in 2005. (True/False)

Ans:

True.

Q.5(h) In which year was the Shah Commission of Inquiry appointed?

Ans:

1977.

Q.5(i) Who started 'Total Revolution'?

Ans:

Jayaprakash Narayan.

Q.5(j) Who was the founder President of Bharatiya Jana Sangha?

Ans:

Syama Prasad Mukherjee.

Q.6 (2 marks each)

Q.6(a) Mention two challenges India faced immediately after independence.

Ans:

- Nation building: integration of princely states and creating unity in diversity after Partition.
- Establishing democracy and economic development: removing poverty and building a democratic constitution.

Q.6(b) Mention two consequences of the Partition of India.

Ans:

- Communal riots and killing of lakhs of people and mass migration of about 80 lakh people creating refugee problems.
- Division of resources and permanent hostility between India and Pakistan (Kashmir problem).

Q.6(c) Who was the official Congress candidate for the Presidential election in 1969? Who won the election?

Ans:

The official Congress candidate was Neelam Sanjiva Reddy; V.V. Giri (supported by Indira Gandhi as an independent candidate) won the election.

Q.6(d) What do you mean by Defection?

Ans:

Defection means an elected representative leaving the party on whose ticket he/she was elected and joining another party (or supporting another party) for personal gain or power. In India defections were common in the 1960s ('Aya Ram, Gaya Ram'), so the 52nd Amendment (1985) added the Tenth Schedule (anti-defection law) and the Speaker can disqualify the member.

Q.6(e) Mention two consequences of the Mizoram Accord signed in 1986.

Ans:

- Peace returned to Mizoram: the MNF gave up arms and Laldenga became the Chief Minister.
- Mizoram became a full state in 1987 (the 23rd state), and its development and political stability improved.

Q.6(f) Mention two features of popular movements in India.

Ans:

- They are mass-based, non-party movements that arise from social issues of people (e.g., environment, livelihood).
- They use non-violent means such as protests, rallies, petitions and awareness campaigns, and they are led by local leaders and activists.

Q.6(g) Write two causes of origin of regionalism in India.

Ans:

- Differences of language, culture, religion and tribe among regions.
- Regional economic imbalance and neglect of some regions by the Centre.

Q.6(h) Write any two features of coalition government in India.

Ans:

- Governments are formed by two or more parties, so no single party has a majority of its own.
- Decisions are taken after consultation, and regional parties get a bargaining role; stability depends on a common minimum programme.

Q.6(i) Write two consequences of 1977 Lok Sabha election.

Ans:

- Defeat of the Congress for the first time at the Centre and formation of the Janata Party government under Morarji Desai (the first non-Congress government).
- End of the Emergency: restoration of civil liberties, press freedom and democracy; Congress lost badly in North India.

Q.6(j) Mention two consequences of National Emergency declared in 1975.

Ans:

- Fundamental rights were suspended and the press was censored; thousands of opposition leaders were arrested.
- The Congress was defeated in the 1977 election and the Janata Party formed the first non-Congress government.

Q.7 (4 marks each)

Q.7(a) Discuss briefly the causes of the dominance of Congress Party in the politics of India after independence.

Ans:

Causes of Congress dominance after independence:

- The Congress led the freedom movement, so it had the legacy and goodwill, along with top leaders like Nehru, Patel and Azad.
- It was a broad 'rainbow' party with a wide organisation, representing all classes, castes, religions and regions.
- The opposition was weak, divided and new; the first-past-the-post (FPTP) system helped the largest party get more seats than its votes.
- Nehru's charismatic leadership and the party's policy of planned development and secularism attracted the people.

Q.7(b) What were the major objectives of Jawaharlal Nehru's foreign policy? Discuss briefly.

Ans:

The major objectives of Nehru's foreign policy were:

- Preserving India's hard-won sovereignty and territorial integrity, and national interest.
- Promoting world peace and opposing colonialism, imperialism and racism; supporting the independence of Asian and African nations.
- Economic development through cooperation with all countries, and not joining military blocs: the policy of non-alignment and the Panchsheel principles.
- Strengthening Afro-Asian unity and the Third World (Bandung Conference 1955, NAM 1961), and support to the UN and disarmament.

Q.7(c) Write a short note on the demands for autonomy in North-East India.

Ans:

Demands for autonomy in North-East India:

- The region has many tribal groups with their own language, culture and traditions; they feared the loss of land and identity because of migration and domination by the plains people.
- Demands for autonomy took the forms of: separate states (Nagaland, Mizoram, Meghalaya), Autonomous District Councils under the Sixth Schedule (Bodoland, Karbi Anglong, Dima Hasao), and demands like Gorkhaland/Kamtapur.

- Reasons: economic backwardness, neglect, lack of infrastructure and fears of becoming minorities.
- The Centre has responded with accords and creation of states and councils; some groups still demand sovereignty or self-determination.

Q.7(d) Discuss the factors that helped BJP to emerge as a dominant political party.

Ans:

Factors that helped the BJP emerge as a dominant party:

- Strong organisation and cadre support from the RSS and its affiliated groups, and the shift from Jana Sangh to BJP (1980).
- Popular mobilisation on issues like Ram Janmabhoomi, which expanded its support base in the 1990s.
- Decline of the Congress, ability to form alliances (NDA) and the leadership of Vajpayee and later Narendra Modi (2014 and 2019 wins).
- Effective use of nationalism, development, welfare schemes, and of social media; and the support of the middle class and OBCs.

Q.7(e) Give suggestions to curb communalism in India.

Ans:

Suggestions to curb communalism in India:

- Promote secular education that teaches tolerance and respect for all religions; remove communal content from textbooks.
- Strict action by the government and courts against hate speech, riots and communal organisations; the media should act responsibly.
- Keep religion out of politics; ban parties that use religion to get votes.
- Encourage inter-faith dialogue and social interaction; improve economic development, jobs and equal opportunity so that there is less scope for communal politics.

Q.7(f) Write a note on India's nuclear policy.

Ans:

India's nuclear policy:

- India conducted its first nuclear test at Pokhran in 1974 (peaceful nuclear explosion) and further tests in May 1998 (Pokhran-II) and became a nuclear weapon state.
- India follows the policy of 'No First Use' and 'credible minimum deterrence'; nuclear weapons are for defence only.
- India did not sign the NPT and CTBT calling them discriminatory, but supports global nuclear disarmament.
- The Indo-US Civil Nuclear Deal (2008) and the NSG waiver helped India to access nuclear fuel and technology for peaceful use.

Q.7(g) Mention two positive and two negative consequences of the Green Revolution.

Ans:

Two positive consequences:

- Food grain production rose sharply and India became self-sufficient.
- Farmers' incomes increased and the rural economy and agriculture-based industry grew.

Two negative consequences:

- Increased inequality between rich and poor farmers and between regions.
- Damage to the soil, water and environment due to chemical fertilisers and pesticides.

Q.7(h) Write any four features of Indian party system.

Ans:

Four features of the Indian party system:

- Multi-party system: many national and regional parties compete in elections.
- Dominance of one party (Congress) for a long time, followed by coalition politics since 1989; later the BJP's rise.
- Rise of regional parties, which play an important role in state and national politics.
- Caste, religion, region and personality play an important role; and lack of internal democracy in parties, and defections.

Q.8 (6 marks each)

Q.8(a) Discuss the changing relations of India with Pakistan.

Ans:

India–Pakistan relations have been changing:

- 1947–1971: conflict over Kashmir (1947–48), wars of 1965 and 1971 (Bangladesh created); Tashkent (1966) and Simla Agreement (1972) tried for peace.
- 1980s–90s: Siachen conflict, Pakistan's support for militancy in Punjab and Kashmir, and nuclear tests by both in 1998.
- 1999–2008: Lahore bus diplomacy (1999), Kargil war (1999), Agra Summit (2001), composite dialogue and trade/people contacts.
- After 2008: Mumbai attack (26/11) set back talks; surgical strikes (2016), Balakot (2019), end of Article 370 (2019), and the ceasefire agreement of 2021.

Relations remain tense, though trade and peace efforts occasionally take place.

Q.8(b) Briefly discuss about the controversies regarding emergency. Was the emergency necessary? (4+2)

Ans:

Controversies regarding Emergency (4 marks):

- Reasons for the Emergency: the government said that there was an 'internal disturbance' due to the JP movement (Total Revolution), strikes (railway strike 1974) and the Allahabad High Court judgment against Indira Gandhi (June 1975). Critics said it was meant to save her office.
- The suspension of rights, press censorship and arrest of leaders (MISA), and compulsory sterilisation excesses (Shah Commission found abuses).
- Debate over whether it was constitutional: Article 352 allows it, but the 'internal disturbance' ground was vague; the Supreme Court (ADM Jabalpur case) refused to protect the right to life during emergency.
- Debate over the role of the President (who accepted the advice without Cabinet approval first).

Was it necessary? (2 marks):

- No, the Emergency was not necessary; the democratic system had enough power to deal with the protests, and it was misused for personal political ends. The Shah Commission (1977) held that it was not justified and many excesses took place. Supporters said it restored discipline and economic order, but the cost to democracy was too high.

Q.8(c) Explain the reasons for the emergence of the Coalition Politics in the Indian Democratic System.

Ans:

Reasons for the emergence of coalition politics in India:

- Decline of the Congress dominance (after 1967 and especially 1989), so no party had a clear majority in the Lok Sabha.
- Rise of regional parties and their demands, which made them important partners in national politics.
- Growth of caste, religion and region-based politics (Mandal, Mandir) leading to fragmentation of the party system.
- Multi-party system and the first-past-the-post (FPTP) electoral system, which split votes; the experiences of the 1989–2014 hung Parliaments.

Q.8(d) What do you mean by planned development? Discuss the role of Planning Commission in the development of India. (2+4)

Ans:

Planning means deciding in advance the goals, resources and methods for achieving economic and social development within a fixed period. In India the Planning Commission was set up in 1950 (replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015) and the Five Year Plans were followed.

Role of the Planning Commission in development:

- It prepared the Five Year Plans and decided priorities for agriculture, industry, power, irrigation and transport.
- It made proper use of limited resources and promoted growth (Green Revolution, steel plants, big dams such as Bhakra-Nangal).
- It worked to remove poverty and unemployment and reduce regional and income inequalities.
- It aimed at self-reliance, social welfare (education and health) and balanced regional development.

Thus planning played an important role, though not all its aims were fully achieved.

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